



STUDY GUIDE

Hearsay (LITERATURE)

Category Overview

Everyone is the hero of their own story. But what happens if the story was never even theirs to tell? 'Hearsay' puts delegates in the room with literature's most condemned characters – monsters, villains, and those condemned by the pages of history. Names that evoke pre-loaded verdicts. Roles that shape stories throughout history. Delegates' convictions for those stances would be seriously tested, as narratives, leaks, and character confessions would either solidify their diagnosis or bring it down, hinting towards what could be considered redeemable.

Round 1: Dispatches

Each team receives a case file on their character: a factual summary of actions, decisions and major events. Delegates would be expected to:

Write a letter to the character, as their assigned guidance counsellor and:

Ask the character what they did and why it caused harm to that character?

Detect and suggest what emotional/psychological impulses could have caused this?

Ask the character one direct question they would ask them if they were in front of the character.

Judging Criteria: (out of 50)

- Quality and structure of the letter (15)
- Use of adequate language (5)
- Satisfactory content for Task 1 (10)
- Satisfactory content for Task 2 (15)
- Satisfactory content for Task 3 (5)

Rules:

- Delegate Cap: 3
- Duration: 1 Hour
- Word Limit: 300-350 words
- Use to AI is strictly prohibited

Round 2: 'The Full Record'

in this round, delegates would start preparing the presentation which they have to present in round 3 and during the time of the round, delegates would also be given access to a witness for 15 minutes to extract a contradicting narrative themselves. The witness would not volunteer information; delegates would have to ask the questions themselves.

After the 15-minute sessions, each team would be given time to:

Reconcile or choose between the two conflicting accounts.

Rebuild their presentation to reflect the information they find credible and then submit said presentation during the round.

There is no judging criteria for this round.

Rules:

- Delegate Cap: 3
- 2 hours



STUDY GUIDE

Hearsay (LITERATURE)

Round 3: 'The Tribunal'

The final round would place teams in front of a sceptical tribunal that would question their final presentation. Each team will be given 15 minutes to rigorously defend their verdict or concede through real-time questioning.

Judging Criteria

- Accuracy of textual information supplied in Round 1 (10)
- Use of information from Round 2 (10)
- Defence of information extracted from Round 2 (15)
- Structure and clarity (15)
- Delivery and composure (10)
- Depth of characterisation and final view (10)

Rules:

- Delegate Cap: 3
- 2 hours